HUMAN RESOURCES AND PAYROLL SYSTEMS

ADP Workforce Now HRIS Implementation and Payroll Transformation

Replacing manual time entry with mobile timekeeping, stronger payroll controls, and integrated employee administration.

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Office Manager, sole internal implementation lead

Executive overview

At National Builders and Acceptance Corporation, I identified manual payroll entry as a significant administrative burden and a preventable source of errors. Our employees worked across multiple rental properties and job sites. Their hours had to be collected and entered into QuickBooks Payroll, while leave balances, employee advances, onboarding paperwork, and other records required separate administrative attention.

I evaluated timekeeping options and selected ADP Workforce Now as a more complete solution. Its mobile application and geofencing capabilities suited a workforce that moved between properties, and its cost was comparable to our existing QuickBooks payroll service. I independently led the implementation for NBAC, including the transition from QuickBooks Payroll, process design, employee and manager training, testing, and ongoing support.

The result was a faster payroll process, more reliable timekeeping, improved leave and reimbursement tracking, and better access to employee information. The project also established stronger controls by connecting timecard review to documented work requests in Buildium, our property management system.

Business challenge

The largest issue was the amount of manual work involved in preparing payroll. Employees performed maintenance and other work at different locations, yet staff hours still required administrative entry. Manual processing took time and increased the risk that a location, job assignment, or hour might be entered incorrectly or left undocumented.

The company also needed a more organized approach to onboarding and employee records. Our existing QuickBooks payroll setup handled payroll, but I wanted employees to have direct access to their time, available vacation and sick leave, and tax documents. I also needed more consistent tracking for employee advances, mileage, and the health insurance reimbursements the owner provided.

System evaluation and selection

I researched alternative timekeeping products before selecting ADP Workforce Now. Every employee had a cell phone, making a mobile solution practical without purchasing separate time clocks for multiple job sites. The ability to use geofencing was especially valuable because maintenance employees could work at several properties in a single pay period.

ADP also offered broader payroll and HR administration at a price comparable to QuickBooks Payroll for our relatively small workforce. Payroll tax processing, digital onboarding, employee records, reporting, and self-service capabilities made it a better fit than a standalone time tracking tool. I was responsible for the selection and implementation decision on behalf of NBAC.

Implementation and workflow design

Employee timekeeping and approval

I established mobile clock-in and clock-out procedures for employees working across different properties. Geofencing helped reinforce which job site employees were reporting from. Bill, our maintenance manager, or Neal, the owner, approved the applicable employee timecards.

I conducted a separate review of every timecard against the maintenance and service requests recorded in Buildium. My purpose was to confirm that time spent at each location was tied to documented work. This was a review across two separate systems, not an automated integration. Early in the transition, it required considerable attention as employees learned the new process. That oversight became less time consuming as timekeeping practices improved.

Training and adoption

I trained all employees on the new system, including how to clock in and out and access their information. I also conducted one on one manager training and provided troubleshooting and support as issues arose. This hands-on rollout was important because employees had different levels of comfort with new technology and needed to use it reliably across changing job locations.

Expanding employee administration

I used the implementation to consolidate processes that had previously required more paperwork or manual follow-up. New employees completed onboarding and employment documentation digitally in ADP. I also established digital records for existing employees while retaining their original paper files.

Employees gained access to their vacation and sick leave balances, including time used and remaining. This helped them plan absences and avoided situations in which someone discovered too late that they did not have enough paid time available. ADP also made it easier to document employee advances authorized by Neal and improved the available payroll and employee reporting.

The system supported W-2 delivery, verification of 1099-related documentation, and mileage reimbursement processing. I also tracked the company's health insurance reimbursement arrangement. NBAC did not offer a conventional group benefits plan, but eligible employees could submit plan documentation for reimbursement of qualifying insurance costs, up to $600 per month per employee under the company's arrangement.

Controlled payroll transition and validation

I managed the changeover from QuickBooks Payroll to ADP with one month of overlap between the systems. During that period, I ran two parallel payroll cycles to compare results and verify the new process before relying on ADP alone.

The first parallel payroll reconciled without discrepancies. In the second, I identified an eight-hour vacation entry that had been requested before implementation and had not been recorded in ADP. I traced the difference to the preexisting leave request, rather than treating the totals as interchangeable or assuming the new system was correct.

This testing helped establish confidence in the payroll changeover while protecting employees from avoidable pay errors. As the process stabilized, the amount of manual payroll entry and follow-up decreased.

Results and business impact

Faster payroll processing. Employee-entered time replaced much of the administrative hour entry required under the previous process.

Stronger payroll accountability. Mobile timekeeping, job-site geofencing, manager approvals, and my independent comparison against Buildium work requests improved the quality and traceability of time records.

Better visibility for employees. Self-service access to leave balances and payroll information reduced uncertainty about time off and made records easier to access.

More organized HR and financial records. Digital onboarding, personnel documentation, employee advance tracking, reimbursement processing, and expanded reports reduced reliance on scattered paper and manual tracking.

Validated transition. Two parallel payrolls provided a controlled move from QuickBooks Payroll to ADP, including investigation of the preexisting vacation entry identified during the second cycle.

Project ownership and capabilities demonstrated

I was the sole NBAC employee responsible for this implementation. I researched and selected the system, carried out the internal setup and transition work, trained employees and the manager, validated payroll, and supported adoption. My work combined technology selection with the operational details that determine whether a system is dependable in daily use.

This project demonstrates HRIS implementation, payroll process improvement, system evaluation, employee training, workflow design, timekeeping controls, data validation, employee self-service, change management, and financial administration.